

**Board 2**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 3

♥ K 6 5 2

♦ K Q J 5 2

♣ 6 3

♠ 9 8 5

♥ Q

♦ A 7 6 4 3

♣ A 10 9 2



♠ Q 10 2

♥ 9 8 7 4 3

♦ 10 9

♣ 8 5 4

♠ A K 7 6 4

♥ A J 10

♦ 8

♣ K Q J 7

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          |       |      | 1 ♠   |
| Pass     | 3 ♠   | Pass | 4NT   |
| Pass     | 5 ♥   | Pass | 6 ♠   |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

6 ♠ by South

Win the ♦ A in dummy. Play the ♥ Q to the ♥ A and ruff the ♥ 10 with dummy's ♠ 8. Play the ♠ 5 to your ♠ A and ruff the ♥ J with dummy's ♠ 9.

Return to your hand with a ♣ and pull another round of trumps with your ♠ K. Leaving the master trump out start playing ♣ winners. Someone may ruff with their master trump but that's the only trick they will get.

It was very bold to bid this slam and North/South were fortunate to find a distribution where it could be made.

But that would have been all for nothing if South had not found the PLAN to make it.

You open 1 ♠ and partner jumps to 3 ♠.

Wow. It looks like you might have a great fit. You bid 4NT and partner responds 5 ♥.

Partner shows 2 Aces so you bid 6 ♠.

South plays 6 ♠. West leads the ♦ K.

**South plays 6 ♠. West leads the ♦ K.**

Losers: ♠ 1? : ♥ 1 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 0 : Total = 2?

If trumps don't split 3-2 you will definitely go down 1, so assume they do split. You could finesse East once in ♥s, or use a ruffing finesse on West, but the cleanest approach is just to ruff two ♥s in dummy. Of course you must do this before you pull trumps.

**Board 4**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 3 2  
 ♥ Q J 10 7 2  
 ♦ J  
 ♣ 9 8 6 2

♠ 9 7 6 4

♥ K 8

♦ A 10 6 2

♣ A Q 3



♠ K 5

♥ A 9 4

♦ K 9 8 7 3

♣ K 10 5

♠ Q J 10 8

♥ 6 5 3

♦ Q 5 4

♣ J 7 4

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          |       |      | 1♦    |
| Pass     | 1♠    | Pass | 1NT   |
| Pass     | 3NT   |      |       |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

3NT by South

**South plays 3NT. West leads the ♥Q.**

Winner count: ♠ 0 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 3 : Total = 7

You need two more winners and you can almost surely get them in ♦s. In fact, if the suit splits 2-2 you could actually get three more winners. But the danger here is that if they **DON'T** split 2-2 and if East happens to win the third ♦ he might lead a ♠. And that might lead to disaster!

Instead, you allow for the possibility that ♦s may not split evenly and you make sure East (the Danger hand) doesn't get the lead. Win the ♥K in dummy. Play the ♦A, (which happens to draw the ♦J from West), then play a small ♦ and finesse with the ♦9. If West can win the trick then the ♦s have split 2-2 and your other 3 ♦s are good. Most importantly though, West cannot lead a ♠ without giving you a trick with your ♠K. If the finesse works, you make 5 ♦ tricks.

Sometimes good play is just visualizing what bad thing might happen.

Here the bad thing would be for East to get the lead and play a ♠. In this case you were able to avoid the bad situation by playing a suit differently than you might have done if there were no danger.

With 13 points and 4 of partner's minor suit you may be tempted to say 2NT or 3♦. Both these temptations should be resisted - your first obligation is to show a 4-card Major if you have one. As poor as the suit is, you still respond 1♠.

Partner comes back with 1NT. (Hint: don't rebid the ♠s.)

Partner has 13/14 points and a balanced hand. You have 13 points and a balanced hand. How about 3NT?

North would play 3NT.

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South plays 3NT. West leads the ♥Q.